DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 5

Technical writer

Profession 5 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A technical writer explains products so users can complete tasks: guides, API documents and help articles.

What professionals do every day

Interviews engineers, tests the steps, writes tasks in order and keeps documents current.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Clear documents cut support tickets and training time.

- Steps that do not work.
- Jargon with no explanation.
- Documents that are out of date.

Skills you need

- Task analysis
- Clarity
- Testing steps
- Version control

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Markdown guide	Plain-text docs	Free	Free	www.markdownguide.org
Docusaurus	Docs sites	Free	Free	docusaurus.io
Google Docs	Drafting and comments	Free	Paid Workspace plans	docs.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write a ten-step task.
Intermediate	Write a README.
Advanced	Build a small help site.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** How-to article.
- **Intermediate:** README and quick start.
- **Advanced:** Help site with search.

Client-ready portfolio project

A quick-start guide for a fictional app, tested by someone who has never used it.

Worked example

Worked example. 'Click Export' becomes 'In the top menu, choose File, then Export, then CSV. The file appears in Downloads.'

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Tested how-to

Business problem: A new app needs a sign-up guide.

Steps

1. List the steps while doing them.
2. Write one action per step.
3. Give the expected result of each step.
4. Ask a new user to follow it.

Expected output: A tested guide.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The tester shows where steps are missing. The guide is corrected and each step names a visible result.

Common mistakes

- Skipping testing.
- Writing for experts only.
- Screenshots without text.
- No version notes.

Freelancing opportunities

- Help documents for software firms.
- README and API guides.
- Briefs for 'technical writer', 'documentation'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- developers.google.com/tech-writing

Part of **Master Freelancing: Writing and Content**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.